

Two or more notes together

Most examples in the Melody chapter of this book have been single lines—just one tone at a time. However, melodies sound richer with even a simple harmony.

Two notes, joined

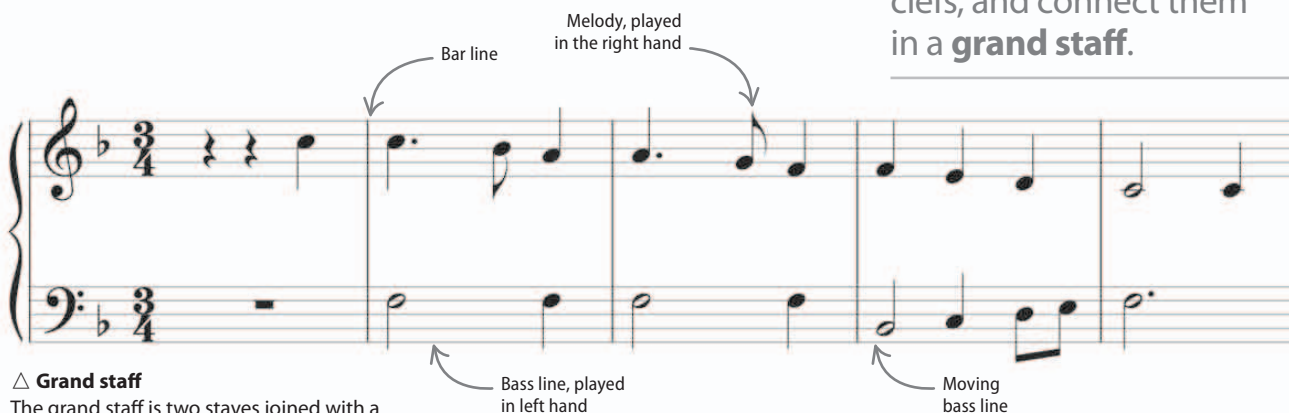
From one line of notes moving parallel with the melody, to a series of chords accompanying a tune, the harmonic aspect of music enhances melodies in a special way. Music sounds fuller and more rewarding when the underlying chordal structure is brought out through harmonizing the melody; unexpected, surprising harmonies bring interest to even simple tunes. Shown here are some common ways to notate harmonies.



△ Two notes, close together

When two tones relatively close in pitch are played together, the simplest way of notating them is to place both note heads on the same stem.

88



△ Grand staff

The grand staff is two staves joined with a brace. It is most commonly used for piano music. Note that the bar lines in both clefs are exactly aligned, making it easy to see which notes are to be played simultaneously.

SEE ALSO

Harmony	118–119 >
Consonance and dissonance	120–121 >
Chord symbols	148–149 >
Words and music	196–197 >
Musical textures	200–201 >

REAL WORLD

Simon and Garfunkel

Paul Simon and Art Garfunkel, a.k.a. the American folk-rock duo “Simon and Garfunkel,” learned to write and sing songs together as teenagers. Throughout the 1950s and 60s, their vocal blend and close harmonizations of Simon’s song melodies brought beauty and intrigue to relatively simple compositions.



When the **notes** to be played simultaneously are **distant**, it is easier to place each voice in its **own clef**, usually treble and bass clefs, and connect them in a **grand staff**.